

Developing Collections for Specific Libraries:

Lake Travis Community Library

Amanda M. Clark

Morgridge College of Education, University of Denver

LIS 4321: Collection Management

Professor Takiyah Jemison

October 14, 2025

Demographic Profile

The Lake Travis Community Library (LTCL) has two branches that serve outer communities of Austin, Texas. Their primary location is in Lakeway, a small town with a population of approximately 19,316 as of 2023 according to the Texas Demographic Center (2023). Their West location is in the unincorporated community of Spicewood, which is about half the size of Lakewood. Originally an affluent retirement community, Lakeway attracted those who could afford to live in lakeside residences on Lake Travis. However, in more recent years, both suburbs of Austin have seen growth in their young family population. The Lake Travis Independent School District (LTISD) is highly-ranked and an attractive public-school option for parents. Due to increases in student enrollment, LTISD has expanded its number of campuses. Additionally, these areas, historically predominately white, are also seeing increases in their Asian and Latino populations. One of the aspects that makes this library system interesting is that while Lakeway is suburban, Spicewood is more rural, with fewer amenities, larger residential parcels, and a longer commute to Austin. LTCL's unified system allows for resource sharing between the two branches but also requires an intentional effort to address any dissimilar needs between its service areas to ensure that the library curates inclusive collections.

Many of the young families that moved into the Central Texas suburbs that surround Austin metro since 2020 were relocating during a technology boom. Between 2010 and 2023, the Austin Chamber of Commerce reported steady job growth in the tech sector at a rate that was almost two times the national average (see Figure 1) (Austin Chamber of Commerce, 2023). The median home price in Central Texas suburban and rural areas is consistently lower than the national average. When taking these two factors together, growth in the population of young families in Lakeway and Spicewood is not surprising but does have some implications for library collection managers. LTCL can enhance the support of family literacy by selecting materials that align with the interests, experiences, and concerns

of these young families, as well as those of their Asian and Latino populations. Moreover, the U.S. Census Bureau reports that the foreign-born population in Lakeway is 32.6% (see Figure 2) (U.S. Census Bureau, 2023). Considering the tech boom attracted many visa holders and the agricultural industry in Spicewood is strong, LTCL can also support these residents by offering essential services like ESL and citizenship classes.

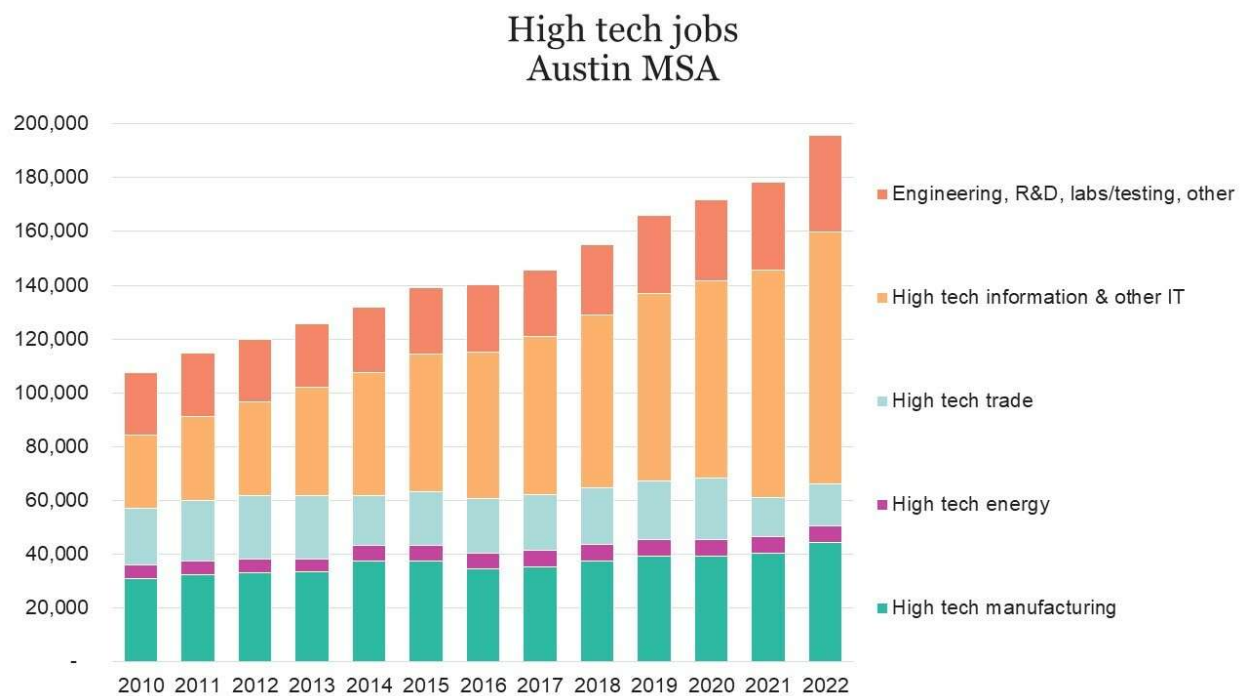


Figure 1 (Austin Chamber of Commerce, 2023)

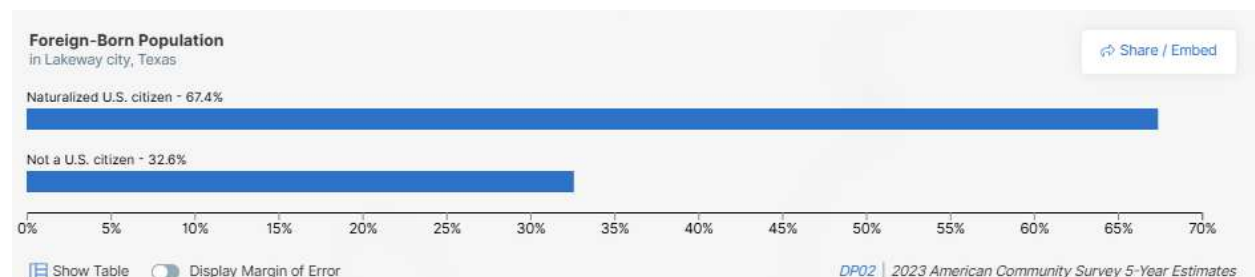


Figure 2 (U.S. Census Bureau, 2023)

Quantitative Analysis of DDC Range

The DDC range that I have selected for this analysis is 649, which contains books on the child rearing aspects of home and family management as well as home care for those with disabilities and illnesses. After eliminating nonbook materials and books that appeared to be assigned to the incorrect DDC location, there were a total of 89 books in this range. This seems to be a decent sized collection for a small town with a larger senior population. Out of the 89, only 10 were currently checked out, which indicated that, quantitatively speaking only, demand is being met as long as other patrons aren't currently on the hold lists for those titles. There did not seem to be any duplicated materials in the selection.

86 books had only one copy available for borrowing, whereas three of the books had two copies. Two of those three titles, *No-drama discipline: the whole-brain way to calm the chaos and nurture your child's developing mind* by Daniel J. Siegel, and *Raising mentally strong kids: how to combine the power of neuroscience with love and logic to grow confident, kind, responsible, and resilient children and young adults* by Daniel G. Amen, were highly acclaimed, research based texts. The third title with two copies available, *The baby name wizard: a magical method for finding the perfect name for your baby* by Laura Wattenberg seems to have been selected because of its commercial success. This suggests that collection staff are utilizing different types of recommendations/reviews to satisfy user needs.

Unfortunately, I was unable to ascertain the availability of any electronic books in this DDC range. LTCL does not make DDC locations available on the public facing catalog for e-materials. The location was simply displayed as "Internet" and most of the electronic materials returned did not belong in the 649 range. While looking for publication information on WorldCat, I did note that many of the print materials listed are generally available as e-books though. Only one book in this collection, a Spanish language book on preparing for breastfeeding, was available to LTCL patrons in a language other

than English. However, in searching through WorldCat, I discovered that 26 of the titles only available in English at LTCL are made available by the publisher in other languages including Spanish, multiple Asian languages, and a handful of other Indo-European languages. Since the Latino and Asian populations in Lakeway and Spicewood are increasing, LTCL might consider increasing the number of offerings in languages other than English.

The most popular publishers in this DDC range included TarcherPerigee (6), Ballantine Books (5), William Morrow (5), Bantam Books (4), Penguin (3), Scribner (3), Harmony (3), DK Pub. (3), Workman Pub. (3), Touchstone (2), Harper (2), Atria Books (2), and McGraw-Hill (2). These publishers accounted for 43 out of the 89 titles in the range at LTCL. The remaining titles (46) were all released by different publishers. All titles in this range were published between 1989 and 2025. Approximately 50% (45) of the titles were published in the last 10 to 11 years, from 2014 through 2025. This indicates that half of the collection is current.

Qualitative Analysis of DDC Range

The subrange selected for the qualitative analysis is 649.1, which contains books on parenting, parenting children by age, and gender specific parenting. After cleaning the data, LTCL holds a total of 25 popular and scholarly titles in this subrange published between 1994 and 2025. 15 of the 25 books (60%) are more than 10 years old but age and quantity alone are not enough to determine the qualitative reasons books might be kept. Upon first glance, I noticed that LTCL held only the oldest edition of every book that had since been revised. In taking a closer look at each of the older titles, both those that had been revised and those that had not, and considering whether they might be held despite their age for specific reasons, I discovered the following: six had very positive reviews despite their age and contained either diverse perspectives or had tips that parents still found useful; three were questionable and might require a closer look as they haven't been reviewed in the last three years or so and were mildly received

prior to that; librarians may consider weeding the final six books because they either haven't received any reviews in the last 10 years or the original edition LTCL carries is obsolete due to the number of revised editions available.

I evaluated the 10 titles with more recent publication dates (2016 – 2025) as well as the older publications mentioned above (1994 – 2015) on other qualitative measures. The first of these was whether there was a wide variation in the themes or subject areas offered within the realm of parenting topics. There were approximately eight broad themes observed including general parenting advice (6), parenting young children (6), parenting teenagers (6), books for mothers only (3), parenting babies (2), parenting boys (1), and parenting girls (1). This is a good array of parenting topics, but some qualitative observations can still be made.

One way to diversify the collection at LTCL might be to investigate acquiring some recent books specific to fathers or male perspectives on parenting. In the 649.1 range, there were three books aimed at mothering. There were not any books specific to parenting for fathers in the 649.1 range, so I looked back in the broader 649 range and found only one book, *The New Father: A Dad's Guide to the First Year*, by Armin A. Brott, published in 1997. This is an important imbalance to note in the quality of a parenting collection as the traditional division of labor in parenting has more recently moved toward more egalitarian co-parenting. Fathers who are the primary caregiver may want to see texts aimed at their specific position. It is hard to say whether fathers may always find themselves in the general parenting books as mothers are generally mentioned and depicted more than fathers in these types of texts. Importantly, LTCL may also consider acquiring books specific to parenting in non-traditional, same-sex, single-parent, blended, and adoptive families.

I touched on books available in other languages in the quantitative section above but found the qualitative perspective on language more useful in assessing the 649.1 range. More specifically, even

though it is true that Lakeway and Spicewood are experiencing increases in their Asian populations, they do not seem to have a large Chinese speaking population. Therefore, the only book available in another language applicable to the population, Spanish, that LTCL collection staff may want to look at adding is *Boundaries with Teens: When to Say Yes, How to Say No*, by John Sims Townsend. Four additional books were available in languages such as Dutch, Polish, Russian, and French but none of these seem to be applicable to the population. Therefore, to diversify the collection at LTCL in terms of language, collections staff may need to look for more books that are not on this list and are available in Spanish and Asian languages other than Chinese.

Data Sets and Pivot Tables

The data sets and pivot tables used in this analysis can be found in Appendix A (secondary file attached in Canvas). The data sets are organized into six tabs across the bottom of the Excel file. Normally I would aggregate the data into a simplified and printable form but, in this context, I thought the wider format clarified my process.

References

Austin Chamber of Commerce. (2023). *High tech industry report*. Austinchamber.com. Retrieved September 29, 2025. <https://www.austinchamber.com/blog/07-05-2023-high-tech-industry>

Texas Demographic Center (2023). Total Population by Place. Retrieved September 29, 2025. <https://demographics.texas.gov/Estimates/2023/>

U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). *2023 American community survey 5-year estimates*. Data.census.gov. Retrieved September 29, 2025. https://data.census.gov/profile/Lakeway_city,_Texas?g=160XX00US4840984

Developing Collections for Specific Libraries:

Lake Travis Community Library

Amanda M. Clark

Morgridge College of Education, University of Denver

LIS 4321: Collection Management

Professor Takiyah Jemison

November 11, 2025

Acquisitions Proposal

To: Lake Travis Community Library District

From: Amanda Clark, Collections Manager

Date: November 11, 2025

Subject: Proposal for acquisition of five new titles

Proposal Summary

This proposal recommends the acquisition of five new titles for the Lake Travis Community Library collection in the 649.1 DDC range. The titles below were selected in keeping with our collection development policy, which prioritizes diverse materials of community interest and anticipated demand. Our selections received positive reviews from multiple platforms, have been vetted by credible non-fiction publishers, and will therefore be useful additions to the collection for our patrons.

Selection Rationale

The titles below were chosen using the following criteria:

- Community relevance: The selected books reflect the growing interests and shifting demographic profile of our locale. A small addition to the collection that speaks to the influx of young families, as well as the interests, experiences, and concerns of the increasing Latino population would benefit the community as a whole.
- Positive reviews: All titles below have received glowing reviews from professional sources such as the Living Now Book Awards, the World Association for Infant Mental Health, the American Book Fest Best Book Award in the Parenting and Family Category, the American Academy of Pediatrics, and The Psychiatry Resource.

- Evidence based: These additional materials will provide parents with scientific, evidence-based, and statistically supported advice on parenting techniques they can use to improve many aspects of their lives and their children's lives.
- Economic value: The benefits derived from the chosen texts are sensible selections given the library's limited acquisitions funds.
- High user engagement: The titles below experience high circulation statistics in larger libraries and may therefore be wise additions to LTCLs current collection.

Proposed Titles

1. Hello, cruel world!: Science-based strategies for raising terrific kids in terrifying times

- **Author:** Melinda Wenner Moyer
- **Subjects:** Parenting, Child Rearing, Information Literacy
- **Publication:** New York : G.P. Putnam's Sons
- **Year:** 2025
- **Justification:** This title is in high demand in larger libraries because it speaks to many current issues that parents face. It offers science-based advice on how parents can help their children navigate issues like gun violence, disinformation, and political polarization. The strategies the author invokes help children cope with adversity, build strong relationships, and develop skills to create stronger futures.
- **Price:** \$30.00

2. Disciplina sin lágrimas (No-drama discipline: The whole brain way to calm the chaos and nurture your child's developing mind. Spanish.)

- **Authors:** Daniel J. Siegel; Tina Payne Bryson; Joan Soler Chic
- **Subjects:** Parenting, Child Development, Child Rearing

- **Publication:** Barcelona : B de Bolsillo, Penguin Random House Grupo Editorial, S.U.A.
 - **Year:** 2018
 - **Justification:** Daniel Siegel and Tina Payne Bryson have co-authored several science-backed texts about parenting and these best sellers have been translated into 40+ other languages for international audiences. In *Disciplina sin Lágrimas*, the authors address the opportunity for parents to use information about their child's neurological development to communicate better with children ages 2-13 who are experiencing big emotions. The Lake Travis Community Library (LTCL) currently holds only one other Spanish language parenting book.
 - **Price:** \$13.95
- 3. Raising good humans every day: 50 simple ways to press pause, stay present, & connect with your kids**
- **Author:** Hunter Clarke-Fields
 - **Subjects:** Parenting, Child Rearing, Psychology
 - **Publication:** Oakland, CA : New Harbinger Publications, Inc.
 - **Year:** 2023
 - **Justification:** This selection assists busy parents by providing actionable tools to help them stay connected to their children despite the overwhelm and day-to-day monotony of family management. The author aids readers with advice on ways to remain mindful and calm in order to form new parenting patterns that will improve how they feel about themselves as parents and their relationship with their children.
 - **Price:** \$18.95
- 4. Lighthouse parenting: raising your child with loving guidance for a lifelong bond**
- **Author:** Kenneth R Ginsburg

- **Subjects:** Parenting, Child Rearing
- **Publication:** Itasca, IL : American Academy of Pediatrics
- **Year:** 2025
- **Justification:** Dr. Kenneth Ginsburg is an expert in the field of adolescent health and has written 5 award-winning parenting books. One of his previous titles, *Raising Kids to Thrive: Balancing Love with Expectations and Protection*, was the recipient of the 2016 Gold Award for parenting books from the Independent Publisher Book Awards. This particular selection focuses on mutual respect, positive discipline, cooperation, and dignity.
- **Price:** \$19.95

5. Free-range kids: how parents and teachers can let go and let grow

- **Author:** Lenore Skenazy
- **Subjects:** Child Rearing, Parent-Child Relations
- **Publication:** Hoboken, NJ : Jossey-Bass, a Wiley brand, Second edition.
- **Year:** 2021
- **Justification:** This title is included for its stimulating, fact-based, and well-researched counter-cultural messages to parents. Skenazy's optimistic perspective on letting go of overprotective, fear-based parenting and replacing it with tactics for empowerment, self-reliance, and resilience is sometimes seen as being in opposition to many of the other parenting books available. However, Skenazy rejects the idea that there is only one way to parent and shares her own practice of parenting for those who may find it beneficial to their children's mental health and self-confidence.
- **Price:** \$22.00

Budget and Marketing

The total estimated cost for these five titles, based on publisher pricing, falls within the allocated funds for this cycle (\$500). Upon approval, the titles will be ordered from a preferred vendor to ensure timely cataloging and availability to patron base. To market these materials to users, the library will create a parenting themed display featuring these five new titles as well as a handful of modern parenting titles already in the collection. Themed displays generally increase circulation through the use of signage, bright colors, high traffic location, and visual appeal. In addition to a physical display, the library's outreach staff is planning on advertising a parenting workshop program that will coincide with the receipt of these titles. This program will be advertised via the library website and will feature these titles, other owned titles, as well as broad community resources that connect parents to partner organizations.

Personal Reflection

This assignment was useful and challenging. I was not previously interested in working in broad collection development, but I enjoyed researching the demographic profile of LTCL's coverage area and analyzing DDC 649 in order to better assess which additional materials might benefit the community. Without access to circulation data, it was difficult to discern how accurate this assessment was. If I were employed at LTCL, I may have been able to gain a better understanding of how useful the parenting books in the collection are to actual patrons by analyzing use statistics. I would also have a closer relationship to the actual patrons and could produce a holistic needs analysis or conduct a patron survey to gather feedback and suggestions for improvement of the collection.

The insights that I gained revolve around how thorough book selectors must become in order to provide well-reasoned acquisitions proposals to library administrators and library boards. The process of reconciling different data sets in order to make informed and strategic decisions is a process I am very familiar with. My previous career as a data analyst was bursting with pivot tables, database downloads,

excel files, and data visualization reports. However, I had not considered the fact that ordering books responsibly required similarly structured considerations. Therefore, merging demographic information like languages spoken with data about the number of books offered in languages other than English was valuable practice. Identifying the increase in the number of young families and then deciding to investigate the 649 DDC range as a result was also valuable practice. The most enjoyable part of this assignment for me was comparing the most popular titles offered in larger libraries to what was missing from LTCL. It was thought-provoking to see what the different review sites and professional associations had to say about the five proposed additions. In looking back over the five titles I chose and acknowledging I came in far under the allotted \$500 budget, the next steps I would take would be to try to select some additional titles that may be of interest to the growing Asian population in Lakeway and Spicewood. Also, I would like to add a few titles that are meant specifically for fathers as that area was lacking in the original analysis.

Overall, I was glad to have performed this analysis. However, in future iterations of this class, I wonder if this same assignment will be possible for students to complete as it is currently written. I was in the middle of this assignment when the U.S. Census Bureau site stopped loading for me. This site would normally help students with the second step of creating a demographic profile but there is currently a notification bar at the top of the site warning users that certain portions of the website are not being updated due to a lapse in funding. If the withdrawal of essential funding continues, it may soon become next to impossible to complete this step accurately barring the availability of more locally derived data. I attempted to utilize state level data from the Texas Demographic Center (TDC) to complete the assignment but the data from the TDC was not as robust as what used to be available from the U.S. Census Bureau. Nonetheless, this project was beneficial, especially given the similar experiences of librarians in the field due to political threats to federal funding and the cessation of IMLS grants.